Incident Investigation Report: Local Discovery Activity on DESKTOP-5OG7C28

Host: DESKTOP-5OG7C28 (Wazuh agent 001 "Windows_VM", 192.168.232.130, WORKGROUP)

Account: DESKTOP-5OG7C28\Darragh Casey (SID S-1-5-21-2586188580-1629295405-1270050116-1001)

Activity date: 27 October 2026

Report date: 27 October 2026

Conventions used in this report. All times are UTC and come from the Sysmon `UtcTime` field or the Windows `systemTime` field. Local time on the host is UTC+1. Wazuh ingestion timestamps run about 6–7 seconds behind event time; for example, record 28318 occurred at 11:34:42.466 and Wazuh received it at 12:34:48.637+01:00. Statements tagged **[Observed]** are taken directly from the telemetry. Statements tagged **[Inferred]** are analytical conclusions drawn from that telemetry.

1. Executive Summary

What happened. On 27 October 2026, between 11:34:41.714 and 11:34:42.641 UTC, an elevated PowerShell process ran a rapid burst of discovery commands. The process was PID 12276, running at High integrity in the context of local user Darragh Casey. In under one second it created 14 processes:

- `hostname` (four times) and `whoami` (twice), launched directly by PowerShell.
- A single chained `cmd.exe /c` command that enumerated local user accounts, the `C:\Users\` profile directory, stored Windows Credential Manager entries, the membership of the built-in Users group, and all local groups.

Independent corroboration. Windows Security auditing confirms two of these actions:

- The Credential Manager enumeration succeeded and returned one stored credential (Event 5379).
- The Builtin\Users group membership was enumerated (Event 4799).

Likely source. The speed and structure of the burst indicate scripted, non-interactive execution. About five minutes earlier, the same user opened `C:\Users\Darragh Casey\Desktop\S_2\Test_2.ps1` in Notepad, and the PowerShell process was working in that same directory. It is therefore inferred, but not proven, that this script, or one closely related to it, was the source of the activity.

What was not seen. The supplied telemetry contains no evidence of:

- network connections or data exfiltration
- file creation or output collection
- persistence
- lateral movement
- account modification
- extraction of credential secrets

Assessment. Treating the activity as hostile, as instructed, it is consistent with the reconnaissance (Discovery) phase that typically follows initial access. It was performed with administrative rights and included reconnaissance of the credential store, which would inform credential access or lateral movement. Severity is assessed as **Medium**.

Alert quality. One Wazuh mapping, T1574.001 DLL Search Order Hijacking, is not supported by the evidence and is rejected. Separately, the `hostname` and `whoami` executions generated no alerts.

Confidence.

Conclusion	Confidence
The discovery activity occurred as described	High
Test_2.ps1 was the source	Medium
The intent of the activity and how access was obtained	Low

2. Scope of Activity

Data supplied. Two files were analysed:

- **Scenario_2_Archives.json:** 23 records.
  - 19 Sysmon events: 17 process creations (Event ID 1) and 2 registry value sets (Event ID 13).
  - 4 Windows Security events: 4624, 4672, 5379 and 4799.
- **Scenario_2_Alerts.json:** 8 Wazuh alerts. Each alert is an exact duplicate of an archive record (Sysmon records 28318–28325) with rule metadata attached. They were analysed once, to avoid double counting.

Completeness within the window. [Observed] The record numbers have no gaps:

- Sysmon records run contiguously from 28307 to 28325.
- Security records run contiguously from 83503 to 83506.

Within the Sysmon and Security channels, therefore, no events are missing between 11:29:36 and 11:34:42 UTC. Any activity that is not visible was either not logged by the host's configuration or occurred outside this window.

Systems and accounts. Exactly one host and one interactive user are involved:

- DESKTOP-5OG7C28, a WORKGROUP (non-domain) machine.
- User Darragh Casey, in terminal session 1.

All discovery commands targeted local resources: the local SAM accounts, local groups, the local profile directory and the user's own Credential Manager vault. **[Inferred]** Because the host is not domain-joined, the account and group enumeration only revealed local information. The one stored credential, however, may relate to an external resource.

Volume of activity of interest. The core activity spans 0.93 seconds, from 11:34:41.714 to 11:34:42.641 UTC, and comprises:

- 14 process creations
- 2 associated security audit events

The preceding events from 11:29:36 to 11:31:51 were reviewed for context. Some are relevant (the Notepad access to Test_2.ps1). Others are background operating-system activity (see 3.6).

Not in scope or not available. The following were not supplied:

- Sysmon records before 28307, including the creation event for the parent PowerShell process.
- PowerShell operational logs (Script Block Logging, Event 4104).
- The contents of Test_2.ps1.
- Any telemetry from other hosts.

3. Detailed Investigation

3.1 Origin process and session context

[Observed] Every discovery command descends from one process:

- **Image:** `C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe`
- **PID:** 12276
- **ProcessGuid:** {4b2ce92d-8a8c-6ae0-6206-000000001a00}
- **Command line:** no arguments (`"C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe"`)
- **Account:** Darragh Casey
- **LogonId:** 0xFCD15
- **Integrity level:** High
- **Terminal session:** 1

The creation event for this PowerShell process is not in the supplied data.

[Inferred] When PowerShell started. Sysmon embeds the process start time, in Unix seconds, in the second and third groups of a ProcessGuid. This interpretation was checked against the logged timestamps and matched every time:

Process	GUID segment	Decoded value	Decoded time (UTC)	Logged UtcTime
Notepad	8b20-6ae0	0x6AE08B20 = 1793100576	11:29:36	11:29:36.280
cmd.exe	8c52-6ae0	0x6AE08C52	11:34:42	11:34:42.460
Group Policy svchost	8b40-6ae0	—	11:30:08	11:30:08
taskhostw	8ba7-6ae0	—	11:31:51	11:31:51

Applying the same method to the PowerShell GUID (8a8c-6ae0) gives a start time of approximately **11:27:08 UTC**. PowerShell had therefore been open for about 7.5 minutes before the discovery burst, and about 2.5 minutes before Test_2.ps1 was opened in Notepad. A start without arguments, in an interactive session, suggests an interactively opened console rather than a script launched directly from another process.

[Inferred] Elevated console. Notepad, launched from Explorer, ran under:

- LogonId 0xFCD57
- LogonGuid {4b2ce92d-5450-6adb-57cd-…}
- Medium integrity

PowerShell ran under:

- LogonId 0xFCD15
- LogonGuid {4b2ce92d-5450-6adb-15cd-…}
- High integrity

Both LogonGuids decode to the same second (about 12:34:24 UTC on 23 October 2026), and the two LogonIds are adjacent. This is the pattern Windows produces when a member of the local Administrators group logs on under User Account Control (UAC): one non-elevated (filtered) token and one elevated token, linked together. The conclusion is that Darragh Casey holds local administrator rights, and that the PowerShell console was explicitly elevated ("Run as administrator").

No privilege-escalation exploit is indicated. The elevation event itself predates the supplied window.

3.2 Access to Test_2.ps1

[Observed] At 11:29:36.280 (Sysmon record 28307), the following process was created:

- **Process:** `explorer.exe` (PID 6780) launched Notepad (PID 8532, from the Microsoft Store WindowsApps path).
- **Command line:** `"C:\Users\Darragh Casey\Desktop\S_2\Test_2.ps1"`
- **Integrity level:** Medium

Two Sysmon Event 13 records followed, at 11:29:38.498 and 11:29:59.612. In both, svchost.exe (PID 2872, running as SYSTEM) updated the Program Compatibility Assistant store entry for Notepad under the user's SID.

[Inferred] What this shows. Opening a `.ps1` file from Explorer launches Notepad by default; the file is viewed or edited, not executed. This event therefore proves that the script was accessed, not that it was run.

[Inferred] Link to the discovery activity. The link is medium confidence, and rests on three points:

- The discovery children of PowerShell (`hostname`, `whoami`) ran with a current directory of `C:\Users\Darragh Casey\Desktop\S_2\`, the same folder that contains Test_2.ps1.
- The same user was involved in both events.
- The discovery activity followed the Notepad access by about five minutes.

A script run inside an existing PowerShell console does not create a new process, so Sysmon Event 1 would not record its execution. Script Block Logging (Event 4104) would be needed to confirm it. No file-creation or file-modification events were supplied, so it cannot be determined whether the script was edited during the Notepad session.

3.3 The discovery burst

[Observed] Direct children of PowerShell PID 12276. These six processes ran from `C:\Users\Darragh Casey\Desktop\S_2\`:

Time (UTC)	Process	PID	Record
11:34:41.714	HOSTNAME.EXE	8624	28312
11:34:41.761	HOSTNAME.EXE	6592	28313
11:34:41.839	HOSTNAME.EXE	5472	28314
11:34:41.871	whoami.exe	11740	28315
11:34:42.134	HOSTNAME.EXE	4068	28316
11:34:42.165	whoami.exe	12012	28317

[Observed] The chained cmd.exe command. At 11:34:42.460, PowerShell launched cmd.exe (PID 1832, record 28318) with this command line:

```
"cmd.exe" /c net user & dir c:\Users\ & cmdkey.exe /list & net localgroup "Users" & net localgroup
```

Its current directory was `C:\Users\DARRAG~1\AppData\Local\Temp\`. Within 181 ms, cmd.exe spawned:

- `net user`, which ran `net1 user` (PIDs 12068 → 6584)
- `cmdkey.exe /list` (PID 7940)
- `net localgroup "Users"`, which ran `net1 localgroup "Users"` (PIDs 8816 → 10484)
- `net localgroup`, which ran `net1 localgroup` (PIDs 6504 → 4912)

The `dir` command is built into cmd.exe and does not create a process, so its execution is known only from the command line. Because `&` runs each command regardless of whether the previous one succeeded, it was presumably attempted.

Process tree:

```
powershell.exe  PID 12276  (High, LogonId 0xFCD15; creation not in data, ~11:27:08 inferred)
  ├─ HOSTNAME.EXE PID 8624   11:34:41.714  [28312]
  ├─ HOSTNAME.EXE PID 6592   11:34:41.761  [28313]
  ├─ HOSTNAME.EXE PID 5472   11:34:41.839  [28314]
  ├─ whoami.exe   PID 11740  11:34:41.871  [28315]
  ├─ HOSTNAME.EXE PID 4068   11:34:42.134  [28316]
  ├─ whoami.exe   PID 12012  11:34:42.165  [28317]
  └─ cmd.exe      PID 1832   11:34:42.460  [28318]
      ├─ net.exe  PID 12068  "net  user"              [28319]
      │   └─ net1.exe PID 6584                        [28320]
      ├─ (dir c:\Users\ - cmd built-in, no process)
      ├─ cmdkey.exe PID 7940 "/list"                  [28321]  → Security 5379 [83505]
      ├─ net.exe  PID 8816   "net  localgroup "Users"" [28322]
      │   └─ net1.exe PID 10484                       [28323]  → Security 4799 [83506]
      └─ net.exe  PID 6504   "net  localgroup"        [28324]
          └─ net1.exe PID 4912                        [28325]
```

[Inferred] Characteristics of the burst.

- **Scripted, not typed.** Fourteen processes were created in 0.93 seconds, and three `hostname` executions fell within 125 ms of each other. A human typing commands cannot work at this speed.
- **Repeated identity checks.** The interleaved `hostname`/`whoami` pattern suggests a script that records host and user context repeatedly, for example before each step or function.
- **Programmatic launch of cmd.exe.** Its working directory (`%TEMP%`, in 8.3 short form) differs from PowerShell's current location (`Desktop\S_2`), which every other child inherited. A native command typed into the console would have inherited `Desktop\S_2`. The

quoted `"cmd.exe"` executable name also points to a launch from code with an explicit working directory, rather than a command typed at the console.
- **No obfuscation.** The double spaces in child command lines (for example `net  user`) are a normal side effect of how cmd.exe rebuilds command lines for chained commands, not a sign of obfuscation.

[Observed] Integrity of the binaries. None of the executed binaries shows signs of masquerading:

- All ran from their standard `C:\Windows\System32\` paths.
- All have `OriginalFileName` values matching their image names and Microsoft Corporation version metadata.

Their hashes are recorded in section 4 for verification against known-good references. Hash reputation could not be checked within the scope of this analysis.

3.4 Credential Manager enumeration

[Observed] Security Event 5379 (record 83505, 11:34:42.570) records a Credential Manager read with the following values:

- **Account:** Darragh Casey (LogonId 0xFCD15)
- **Read operation:** %%8100 (Enumerate Credentials)
- **Return code:** 0
- **countOfCredentialsReturned:** 1
- **clientProcessId:** 7940
- **processCreationTime:** 11:34:42.556

Both the PID and the creation time match `cmdkey.exe /list` exactly (record 28321).

[Inferred] The enumeration succeeded and revealed that one credential is stored in the user's vault. `cmdkey /list` exposes the target name, credential type and username, but not the secret. However, knowing which saved credential exists tells an attacker which resource to target next, for example via RDP or a network share using that stored credential. Which credential it was cannot be determined from the telemetry.

3.5 Assessment of the Wazuh alerts

Each alert was assessed against its underlying event rather than accepted at face value.

Rule 92052 (level 4) — "Windows command prompt started by an abnormal process", T1059.003. Fired on record 28318. The underlying behaviour is real: PowerShell spawned cmd.exe. PowerShell launching cmd.exe is common in legitimate administration, so the alert is only significant because of the commands it carried. **Verdict: true positive for the behaviour; malicious relevance comes from the context.**

Rule 92036 (level 3) — "net.exe started by a Windows cmd shell", T1059.003 and T1574.001. Fired three times, on records 28319, 28322 and 28324. The cmd.exe → net.exe relationship is accurate. The T1574.001 (DLL Search Order Hijacking) mapping, along with its Persistence, Privilege Escalation and Defense Evasion tactics, is **not supported**:

- net.exe executed from its canonical System32 path.
- No DLL load (Sysmon Event 7) or DLL file creation events exist.
- No non-standard binary location is involved.

The mapping appears to be a generic attribute of the rule, not something established by this event. **Verdict: true positive for execution; the ATT&CK mapping is a false attribution.**

Rule 92031 (level 3) — "Discovery activity executed", T1087. Fired three times, on net1.exe records 28320, 28323 and 28325. The underlying evidence supports it.

- `net1 user` is local account discovery.
- The two `net1 localgroup` executions are more precisely Permission Groups Discovery (T1069.001), which the rule does not map.

Verdict: true positive; the mapping is partially accurate.

Rule 92032 (level 3) — "Suspicious Windows cmd shell execution", T1087 and T1059.003. Fired on cmdkey.exe, record 28321. Enumerating the credential vault is supported, and Event 5379 corroborates it. T1087 (Account Discovery) is an imprecise description of what cmdkey does (see section 6). **Verdict: true positive; the mapping is imprecise.**

Detection gaps.

- The four `hostname` and two `whoami` executions (records 28312–28317) generated no alerts, even though they are classic host and user discovery.
- Event 5379 (credential enumeration) and Event 4799 (group membership enumeration) also generated no alerts.

Prior firings. The `firedtimes` counters show these rules had fired earlier within the manager's counting period:

- 92031 had fired 13 times before this burst.
- 92052 had fired 4 times before.

Those earlier events, on this agent or others, were not supplied, so similar earlier activity cannot be ruled out.

3.6 Events excluded as unrelated background activity

Group Policy service start (Sysmon 28310, Security 83503 and 83504, all at 11:30:08.786–.788):

- services.exe (PID 808) started `svchost.exe -k GPSvcGroup` (PID 7360) as SYSTEM.
- Event 4624 records a Type 5 (service) logon by SYSTEM via services.exe. The process ID in that event, 0x328, equals PID 808.
- Event 4672 records the standard SYSTEM privilege set.

This is routine Group Policy Client service activity. It has no process or session relationship with PID 12276 and does not affect the interpretation.

taskhostw.exe (Sysmon 28311, 11:31:51.229): a SYSTEM, session 0 instance from the standard path, with no child activity in the data. Its parent appears as PID 8 with a null GUID and no image; this is an unresolved parent, which is a minor logging anomaly. Nothing links it to the user session or to the PowerShell process tree, so it is assessed as scheduled-task infrastructure. The unresolved parent is noted for completeness.

Program Compatibility Assistant registry writes (Sysmon 28308 and 28309): routine compatibility tracking by Windows. Their only relevance is that they corroborate Notepad's execution under the user's SID.

3.7 Evidence gaps and things not observed

Not observed in the supplied telemetry:

- Sysmon Event 3 (network connections)
- Event 11 (file creation)
- Event 10 (process access, e.g. to LSASS)
- Event 7 (image loads)
- Account creation or modification (4720 or 4732)
- New logons from remote sources

The Sysmon records are contiguous, so if those event types were enabled, none occurred in the window. Whether they are enabled cannot be confirmed. The command line contains no redirection to a file (>), so the discovery output most likely went to the console or was captured inside PowerShell.

[Inferred, low confidence] Unlogged process creations. If the ProcessGuid's third group is read as a creation sequence counter, it increases steadily: 0x0662 for PowerShell, 0x0682 for Notepad, 0x068C for cmd.exe, 0x068E for the first net.exe. This reading implies two things:

- One process was created between cmd.exe and net.exe (counter 0x068D) without Sysmon logging it. The record IDs are contiguous, so this was a configuration exclusion; a console host (conhost.exe) is the most plausible candidate.
- About 31 processes were created between the start of PowerShell and the Notepad launch (11:27:08–11:29:36). Their records fall before 28307 and were not supplied.

Activity in that earlier window is therefore unknown and should be retrieved.

4. Evidence Analysis

E1 — Elevated PowerShell as the common parent. Records 28312–28318 all have:

- ParentProcessId 12276
- ParentProcessGuid {4b2ce92d-8a8c-6ae0-6206-000000001a00}
- ParentImage `powershell.exe`
- IntegrityLevel High
- LogonId 0xFCD15

This establishes a single source process for the whole burst. The GUID linkage is stronger evidence than the PID alone.

E2 — Script access. Record 28307:

- Image: `Notepad.exe`
- CommandLine ends in `"C:\Users\Darragh Casey\Desktop\S_2\Test_2.ps1"`
- ParentImage: `C:\Windows\explorer.exe` (PID 6780)
- IntegrityLevel: Medium; LogonId 0xFCD57

Records 28312–28317 have CurrentDirectory `C:\Users\Darragh Casey\Desktop\S_2\`. Together these support the (inferred) association between the script and the burst.

E3 — Account enumeration. Records 28319 and 28320: `net user` (PID 12068), followed by `C:\WINDOWS\system32\net1 user` (PID 6584). The ParentProcessGuid chain runs …8c06… (cmd.exe) → …8e06… (net.exe) → …8f06… (net1.exe).

E4 — Credential store enumeration. Record 28321: `cmdkey.exe /list` (PID 7940, 11:34:42.556). It is corroborated by Security 5379 (record 83505), whose clientProcessId 7940 and processCreationTime 11:34:42.5563526Z match exactly, with countOfCredentialsReturned 1 and returnCode 0.

E5 — Local group enumeration. Records 28322–28325:

- `net localgroup "Users"` (PID 8816) → `net1` (PID 10484)
- `net localgroup` (PID 6504) → `net1` (PID 4912)

Security 4799 (record 83506) records the Users group (S-1-5-32-545, Builtin) being enumerated by Darragh Casey (LogonId 0xFCD15). Its callerProcessId 0x28f4 equals decimal 10484, which matches net1.exe in record 28323 exactly.

E6 — Host and user discovery. Records 28312, 28313, 28314 and 28316 are `HOSTNAME.EXE`; records 28315 and 28317 are `whoami.exe`. All have parent PID 12276.

E7 — Evidence of automation.

- Sub-second spacing across all of records 28312–28325, which span 927 ms.
- cmd.exe's working directory (`C:\Users\DARRAG~1\AppData\Local\Temp\`) differs from its siblings' (`Desktop\S_2`).
- The cmd.exe command line quotes its own executable name.

E8 — Elevated token. The LogonGuid pair {…5450-6adb-15cd…} (High integrity) and {…5450-6adb-57cd…} (Medium integrity) share a creation time, consistent with UAC linked tokens.

Reference hashes (SHA-256, for verification against known-good references):

Binary	SHA-256
cmd.exe	15CD209C995B7D3009C91CA40892D5B8F1FB162F3E5F10716642EA278E8E0D7B
net.exe	BB3E638C8B5B6EF80847E364AEEF2796CAD25D3539CF9B41D3820FA48943E777
net1.exe	8489DB35375D890314EB8F7CD9E0CBD3866475F4E252865F00F649B0A02FD757
cmdkey.exe	4125CD7966810CDFAFB18157C276A88E6AC443C7C98D42593C70247045815028
HOSTNAME.EXE	F8B207720D8673FEB5839DF1E52360F72C2AD2CE9917D5F3DA4F30368DC747C9
whoami.exe	23240EF9F8B0A9A324110B1C2331DE31DC1B0E08F5359CB707E51A939AF56CD3
Notepad.exe	03745E9E21684C0E6D9FDC50D91CAA0935F4BAF50F626C11987AB7D6991D58D1

5. Timeline of Events

Time (UTC, 27 Oct 2026)	Record	Event	Relevance
~11:27:08	Inferred from GUID	powershell.exe PID 12276 starts, High integrity, no arguments	Source process (creation event not supplied)
11:27:08–11:29:36	Not supplied	About 31 process creations implied by the GUID sequence	Unknown; gap
11:29:36.280	Sysmon 28307	explorer.exe opens Test_2.ps1 in Notepad (PID 8532), Medium integrity	Script accessed
11:29:38.498	Sysmon 28308	PCA registry write for Notepad (svchost PID 2872)	Benign corroboration
11:29:59.612	Sysmon 28309	Second PCA registry write for Notepad	Benign corroboration
11:30:08.786–.788	Security 83503, 83504; Sysmon 28310	SYSTEM service logon (Type 5); Group Policy svchost PID 7360 starts	Background, excluded
11:31:51.229	Sysmon 28311	taskhostw.exe PID 11976 (SYSTEM, unresolved parent)	Background, excluded
11:34:41.714	Sysmon 28312	HOSTNAME.EXE PID 8624	Discovery begins
11:34:41.761	Sysmon 28313	HOSTNAME.EXE PID 6592	Discovery
11:34:41.839	Sysmon 28314	HOSTNAME.EXE PID 5472	Discovery
11:34:41.871	Sysmon 28315	whoami.exe PID 11740	Discovery
11:34:42.134	Sysmon 28316	HOSTNAME.EXE PID 4068	Discovery
11:34:42.165	Sysmon 28317	whoami.exe PID 12012	Discovery
11:34:42.460	Sysmon 28318	cmd.exe PID 1832 with chained discovery command (alert 92052)	Command shell execution
11:34:42.507	Sysmon 28319	net user, PID 12068 (alert 92036)	Account discovery
11:34:42.527	Sysmon 28320	net1 user, PID 6584 (alert 92031)	Account discovery
—	None (cmd built-in)	`dir c:\Users\` (command line only)	Profile directory discovery
11:34:42.556	Sysmon 28321	cmdkey.exe /list, PID 7940 (alert 92032)	Credential store enumeration
11:34:42.570	Security 83505	5379: credentials enumerated, 1 returned	Confirms success
11:34:42.573	Sysmon 28322	net localgroup "Users", PID 8816 (alert 92036)	Group discovery
11:34:42.592	Sysmon 28323	net1 localgroup "Users", PID 10484 (alert 92031)	Group discovery
11:34:42.612	Security 83506	4799: Builtin\Users membership enumerated by PID 10484	Confirms success
11:34:42.618	Sysmon 28324	net localgroup, PID 6504 (alert 92036)	Group discovery
11:34:42.641	Sysmon 28325	net1 localgroup, PID 4912 (alert 92031)	Last observed event

6. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic	Technique	Evidence	Support
Execution	T1059.001 PowerShell	PowerShell PID 12276 is the parent of every discovery process (28312–28318). The script	Supported (inferred mechanism)

		content was not observed.	
Execution	T1059.003 Windows Command Shell	`cmd.exe /c` with five chained commands (28318)	Supported (observed)
Discovery	T1082 System Information Discovery	`hostname` ×4 (28312, 28313, 28314, 28316)	Supported (observed; not alerted)
Discovery	T1033 System Owner/User Discovery	`whoami` ×2 (28315, 28317)	Supported (observed; not alerted)
Discovery	T1087.001 Account Discovery: Local Account	`net user` / `net1 user` (28319, 28320). `dir c:\Users\` also reveals profile names.	Supported (observed; dir from command line only)
Discovery	T1069.001 Permission Groups Discovery: Local Groups	`net localgroup "Users"` and `net localgroup` (28322–28325); Security 4799 (83506)	Supported (observed and corroborated)
Discovery	T1083 File and Directory Discovery	`dir c:\Users\` inside the cmd.exe command line (28318)	Partially supported (built-in; no direct execution telemetry)
Credential Access	T1555.004 Credentials from Password Stores: Windows Credential Manager	`cmdkey /list` (28321); Event 5379 shows one credential enumerated (83505)	Partially supported: the vault was enumerated, but no secret extraction was observed. Best read as reconnaissance of the credential store.
Persistence, Privilege Escalation, Defense Evasion	T1574.001 DLL Search Order Hijacking (Wazuh rule 92036)	No DLL loads, DLL writes or non-standard paths; net.exe ran from System32	**Not supported; rejected**

The elevated (High integrity) context was obtained through a legitimate UAC split token. No privilege-escalation technique is evidenced.

7. Overall Investigation Conclusion

Summary. Within the supplied telemetry, an elevated PowerShell session belonging to the local administrator-equivalent account Darragh Casey ran an automated reconnaissance sequence on DESKTOP-5OG7C28. In under one second it identified:

- the host name and the current user
- local user accounts and user profile directories
- the membership of the local Users group and all local groups
- the contents of the user's Windows Credential Manager vault, which held one stored credential

Treated as hostile activity, this is a typical post-access discovery stage: an adversary establishing where they are, who they are running as, which accounts and groups exist, and which saved credentials could enable the next move. No later stages were observed in the supplied data: no credential theft, persistence, lateral movement, command-and-control or exfiltration. The immediate impact is limited to information disclosure. The significance lies in what the activity precedes, and in the fact that it ran with administrative privileges.

Observed facts:

- The 14 process creations, their command lines, parent-child relationships, timing, user, LogonId and integrity level.
- Successful Credential Manager enumeration returning one credential (5379).
- Successful enumeration of the Users group membership (4799).
- Test_2.ps1 opened in Notepad from Explorer at 11:29:36.
- No events in the Sysmon or Security channels between records 28307 and 28325 indicating further malicious actions.

Inferences:

- The activity was scripted rather than typed.
- Test_2.ps1, located in the PowerShell working directory and opened five minutes earlier, is the probable source.
- The PowerShell console was started at about 11:27:08 and elevated through UAC.
- The account holds local administrator rights.
- cmd.exe was launched programmatically with an explicit working directory of `%TEMP%`.
- At least one process creation between cmd.exe and net.exe went unlogged.
- The T1574.001 alert mapping is a false attribution.

Unresolved:

- How the session or script reached the host (initial access).
- Whether Test_2.ps1 was actually executed, and what it contains.
- Activity between 11:27:08 and 11:29:36.
- Whether the discovered credential was later used.
- What occurred after 11:34:42.641.

Lab context. The host name "Windows_VM", the folder "S_2" and the file name "Test_2.ps1" are consistent with a controlled test. As instructed, these were not used to discount the activity.

Recommended next steps:

1. Collect Test_2.ps1 and hash it.
2. Retrieve PowerShell Operational logs (Events 4103 and 4104) and Sysmon records before 28307 and after 28325, to cover the

gaps described above.
3. Identify the stored Credential Manager entry, and rotate the credential if the activity cannot be attributed to authorised use.
4. Confirm with the account owner whether they launched the elevated console and the script.
5. Tune detection: add coverage for `hostname`/`whoami` bursts and for Events 5379 and 4799, and correct the T1574.001 mapping on rule 92036.

Severity: Medium.

Overall confidence: High. The core finding (that this discovery and credential-store enumeration occurred, from this process and account, at these times) is directly observed and independently corroborated by Security auditing. Confidence is lower for the elements beyond that core finding:

- **Medium** that Test_2.ps1 was the source.
- **Low** for intent and initial access, which the supplied evidence does not address.